

Hunt, Lujan To Start For Miner Nine Today

By RODGER MCKNOWN

Lynn Hunt and Jesse Lujan are slated to get the nods as starting pitchers for the Miners Friday when University of Texas at El Paso opens its 1968 baseball with a doubleheader at Dudley Field against University of New Mexico.

First game of the twin bill is set for 11 a.m. with the second game to follow about 20 minutes after the end of the first.

Hunt and Lujan were the mainstays in the Miner mound staff last season, winning eight games each, and coach Andy Cohen is counting on them to handle a good share of the hurling duties again this year.

Hunt, a southpaw, compiled an 8-3 record last season with a 1.73 earned run average. Lujan had an 8-1 mark with a 4.12 earned run average.

The righthanded Lujan is a 5-foot-9, 150-pound sophomore. Hunt, a junior, is 5-foot-10½ and weighs 168 pounds.

The same two teams meet again at 10 a.m. Saturday in a single game at Dudley Field.

Cohen is undecided on his starting hurler for the Saturday contest. If he wants a lefthander, it will probably be Terry Witt, a freshman from Andress High, or Bill Onick, a freshman from Irvin. If Cohen decides to go with a righthander, the probable choice would be

Bill Diesselhorst, a freshman from Fairfax, Va.

The Miners appear to be well set in the hitting and fielding department. Choen has all but one player returning from a squad that compiled a team batting average of .326 last season. Seven of the returnees topped the .300 mark.

Charlie West, the Miner's All-America safety in football, tops the returning hitters. In 1967, he had a .366 average with 10 home runs and drove in 48 runs.

West will be returning to the outfield along with John Murphy. And the entire infield from the 1967 crew returns. The Miners compiled a team fielding average of .948 last season.

Probable starters in the infield for U. T. El Paso are John Miller at first base, Juan Sandoval at second, Danny Blanco at third and Robert Aguirre at shortstop.

In the outfield, it will be West in center, junior college transfer Mike Ward in left and right field will be between John Murphy and Sam McLellan. Ronnie Hix, another JC transfer, is the probable starter behind the plate.

Cohen will probably shake up his line-up somewhat in the second game in order to get a look at some other players who have done well in practice this spring.

In six games with New Mexico last season, the Miners came out on top with a 3-2-1 record. U. T. El Paso had a 25-12-1

season mark, the best in the history of the sport at Minerland.

UNM coach Bob Leigh has three of the top seven hitters returning from last season's team that posted a 24-19-1 record. Third baseman Greg With tops the list with a .316 mark. Leigh has filled in his infield with a pair of JC transfers, Jim Palmer at second and Jim Johnson at shortstop.

Righthanders Bob McAulay and Ralph Saltee are expected to be the starters on the mound for the Lobos in the doubleheader. Saltee, with 116 strikeouts, was among the national leaders in that department last season. He posted a 7-4 record with a 2.34 earned run average.

McAulay was 6-4 in 1967 with a 4.82 ERA but appears to have returned to the form he enjoyed in 1966 when he had a tremendous sophomore season.

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